The Supreme Court first upheld his death sentence and then reduced it to life term after he cited in an appeal the eleven-year delay by the government in deciding his mercy petition. As per media reports, the apex court forwarded his case to the governor of Tamil Nadu to decide his remission petition.

ROBERT PAYAS (27): Gave refuge to the mastermind

With help from Murugan, he gave shelter to Sivarasan in his house in Madras before and after the assassination. A Sri Lankan Tamil, Payas had come from Jaffna in September 1990 and sought political asylum in Tamil Nadu. He was accompanied by his wife. His plea before the authorities was that he had lost his child in the atrocities committed by the IPKF. Later, he took a vow to avenge his loss. Payas confessed his role in hatching the conspiracy to kill Rajiv Gandhi and was convicted.

Payas is currently serving life term in jail.